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Hiring Team
Blackhawk Network
Technology Internship Program

Dear Hiring Team,

I'm writing to apply for the Technology Intern position for Summer 2027. I'm a Computer Network System Management student in the Engineering Technology program at San José State University with a 3.97 GPA, and I hold the CompTIA Security+ certification. I'm most interested in the Cyber Security track, and the fraud and risk work in your posting is a big part of why.

My closest experience to that work is detection. I built an isolated lab in VirtualBox with Kali Linux, Metasploitable, and a Wazuh SIEM server, then set up rule-based detection for brute-force attempts and file integrity events. I tested it by running my own simulated attacks, and it caught all three attempts in under five minutes each. I learned to define what suspicious activity looks like, write a rule for it, and check whether the rule works.

I used the same idea in an IT helpdesk triage agent I built in Python on Google's Agent Development Kit, with a custom MCP tool server. It routes tickets to auto-resolve, security escalation, or human review, and I tested it against 20 tickets and a 17-test suite. I added a screening layer that catches prompt-injection and phishing attempts before the text reaches the model. Testing is what makes an automated decision trustworthy, which matters even more when the systems handle financial transactions.

I also built an interactive Security+ study site in JavaScript with an 800-question bank, a simulated Linux shell, and a strict same-origin content security policy. I wrote automated test harnesses for it and deployed it publicly, which gave me a first look at building, testing, and shipping a project end to end. I used AI assistance on it and said so openly.

I'm still early in my programming and algorithms coursework, and I haven't worked with Spark, Kinesis, or large-scale data systems yet. I do follow through on projects I start, I document my work on GitHub, and I pick up new tools quickly. Thank you for considering my application. I would welcome the chance to talk about how I can contribute to your team next summer.

Sincerely,

Jared Lomeli